

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's review!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations

Ask your partner:

- Which Hollywood actors do you think perform their own stunts?
- If you were an actor, would you have a stunt person or would you perform your own stunts? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about when, where, how or why something is done.
- I can describe people, events or things.
- I can report facts or talk about untrue or possible events.

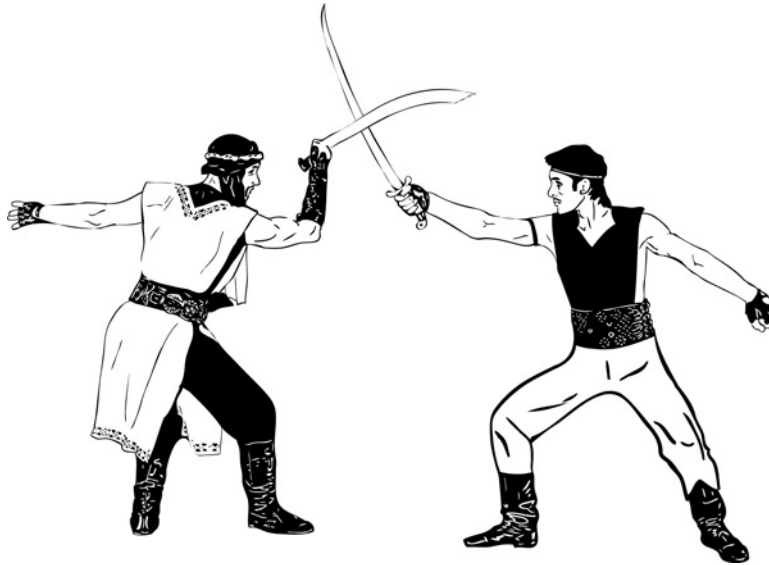




Let's Explore!

Learning the ropes*.

* To "*learn the ropes*" means to understand how to do a particular job.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

When people choose a movie or television show to watch, they tune in because they want to see their favorite actors or a thrilling story. What they don't realize is that wherever films are being produced, some of the most important people on the set are the stunt people. The earliest stunts were performed by circus acrobats. They were reported to have worked without the help of nets or safety harnesses. Audiences must have been alarmed to see these daredevils free falling with no protection whatsoever. Eventually, stunt performers were employed by live theater acts, and finally by early cinema.

As more and more big budget special effects were featured in productions, they began to rely more heavily on these dedicated professionals. But how do stunt people prepare for their distressing and unsettling job?

There are a few schools for stunt people, mainly in California, but many "learn the ropes" by doing the actual job, the way a welder or an artist might. Many follow the same trajectory as noted stuntman Jim West. "At first, I may have been hired to do a few small stunts because of my athletic ability," he said. "But slowly, as I learned from other stunt people, I mastered a greater variety of stunts safely and convincingly."

Being a stunt person is an exhilarating and difficult profession, but it is rarely a gratifying one, given that the glorified lead actors seem to get all the credit. The stunt people must be satisfied with having participated in the production. Without these men and women who almost never become famous, the movies and TV shows we love just wouldn't be the same.





Let's Practice!

Here's everything you need to know about stunt people.

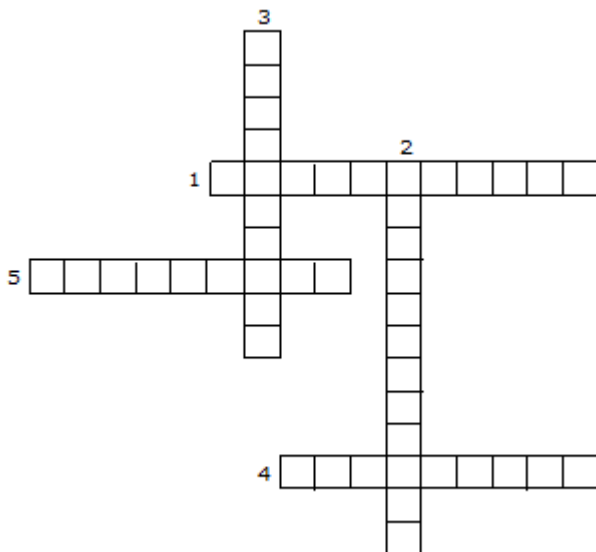
Instructions: Complete the crossword by reading the hints you are given. Use the words to complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Down

2. Being a stunt person is an e_____ and difficult profession.
3. It is rarely a g_____ job, given that the glorified lead actors seem to get all the credit.

Across

1. But how do stunt people prepare for their d_____ job?
4. The audience wants to feel s_____.
5. The audience tunes in because they want to see their favorite actors or a t_____ story.



Let's Practice!

Here are some unsettling facts about stunts.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences below. Circle the incorrect words. Rewrite the sentences below. Practice reading them aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. The earliest stunts was performed for circus acrobats.
2. Stunt performers were employed per live theater acts.
3. Some performers were hiring because of their looks.
4. Stunts were a major attractions for most people.
5. A dangerous stunt were always avoided by amateurs.





Extension Activity

Investigate a strange profession.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research a profession that you know very little about.
- Make notes on the history of the profession.
- Make notes on the the training requirements for one who chooses this profession.
- Present your findings to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research an unknown profession.

☐ ☐

I give background information.

☐ ☐

I talk about how something is done.

☐ ☐

I share my findings with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **distressing** (adjective): upsetting or worrying
e.g. How do stunt people prepare for their distressing and unsettling job?
- **exhilarating** (adjective): causing a feeling of excitement
e.g. Being a stunt person is an exhilarating and difficult profession.
- **gratifying** (adjective): satisfying or pleasing
e.g. It is rarely a gratifying profession.
- **satisfied** (adjective): contented or pleased
e.g. The stunt people must be satisfied with having participated in the production.
- **glorified** (adjective): important or honored
e.g. The glorified lead actors seem to get all the credit.
- **thrilling** (adjective): very exciting or exhilarating
e.g. They tune in because they want to see their favorite actors or a thrilling story.
- **unsettling** (adjective): disturbing; makes you feel worried
e.g. How do stunt people prepare for their distressing and unsettling job?





Learning Points

Adverbial Clauses: When, Where, How and Why

An **adverbial clause** is a group of words which have the same function as an adverb. Like all clauses, an adverbial clause has a subject and a verb.

- **Adverbial clauses of time** are used to express when something happens or how often something happens. You can use a **subordinating conjunction** like **after, as, as long as, as soon as or until** to introduce the adverbial clause.

Example:

I'm going to register at my local gym as soon as I get paid.

I'll train until I start seeing results.

- **Adverbial clauses of place** are used to express where something happens. An adverb of place often starts with a preposition like **in, on or near**.

You can use a **subordinating conjunction** like **anywhere, everywhere, where or wherever** to introduce the adverbial clause.

Example:

Danielle tries to climb a mountain wherever she travels to.

She is willing to travel anywhere mountains can be found.

- **Adverbial clauses of manner** are used to express how something happens. An adverb of manner often starts with a **subordinating conjunction** like **as, like or the way...** to introduce the adverbial clause.

Example:

Bungee jumpers still jump from cliffs the way the original creators of the sport had intended.

They see danger as an unnecessary feeling that gets in the way of enjoying the jump into the void.

- **Adverbial clauses of cause** are used to express how something happens. An adverb of cause often starts with a **subordinating conjunction** like **as, because, given or since ...** to introduce the adverbial clause.

Example:

Organizers didn't know how to prevent the accident, given the short time it took for Gina to perform her jump.

Since Gina was a celebrated world-class jumper, the organizers thought everything would go according to plan.

Examples:

- *When people choose a movie or television show to watch, they tune in because they want to see their favorite actors or a thrilling story.*
- *Wherever films are being produced, some of the most important people on the set are the stunt people.*
- *It is rarely a gratifying profession, given that the glorified lead actors seem to get all the*





Learning Points

credit.

- Many "learn the ropes" by doing the actual job, the way a welder or an artist might.

Report Facts or Talk About Untrue or Possible Events

You use the **active voice** when you want the 'doer' of the action to be the subject.

You use the **passive voice** when you want the 'receiver' of the action to be the subject.

You can use the **passive voice** when you want to report events that happened in the past in a general way.

You use the **passive form of Modal verbs** to put the emphasis on the receiver of the action, and to suggest possibility, certainty, injunction or prohibition.

Most of spoken English uses **active speech**. When you use an **active sentence** to report an event, the subject is the focus of the sentence.

Example:

- *Extreme Sports Africa (subject) organized this centenarian's jump (object).*

A **passive sentence** puts the emphasis on the object of the active sentence. When you use a **passive sentence** to report an event, the object of the active sentence now becomes the subject and focus of the passive sentence.

Example:

- *This centenarian's jump (subject) **was organized by** Extreme Sports Africa (object).*

You can use the **Simple Past passive** form to report events in an impersonal way. The subject is not specific, but general.

Example:

- **It was reported that** *Marion Van Loon became the first person over 100 to parachute out of a plane.*

You make the **passive form** of a verb by using tenses of the be verb followed by the past participle.

As with other verbs, the **passive form of modal verbs** puts the emphasis on the receiver of the action and not on the doer of the action.

Passive modal forms are often impersonal and do not require an object.

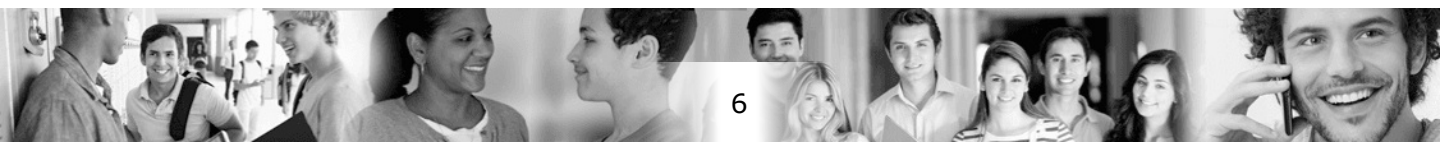
Example:

- *Bungee jumping should be enjoyed in a safe and responsible environment.*
- *Some of the best jumps in the world may be enjoyed from these cliffs.*

The structure of **Simple Present passive for modal verbs** is:

subject+modal verb+be+past participle of verb

You can use **Simple Present modal verbs** to convey a general obligation or a permission.





Learning Points

The structure of Simple Past passive for modal verbs is:

subject+modal verb+have been+past participle of verb

Example:

- *Bungee jumping must have been seen as a rite of passage.*
- *Bungee jumping might have been introduced to the western world by Captain James Cook, though no one is really sure about that historical fact.*

You can use Simple Past modal verbs to convey certainty, possibility, or uncertainty about a past event or situation.

Examples:

- *They were reported to have worked without the help of nets or safety harnesses.*
- *Eventually, stunt performers were employed by live theater acts, and finally by early cinema.*
- *Audiences must have been alarmed to see these daredevils free falling with no protection whatsoever.*
- *The earliest stunts were performed by circus acrobats.*

